

Trivia for keyboard geeks

Don't call yourself a keyboard geek if you don't know these facts!

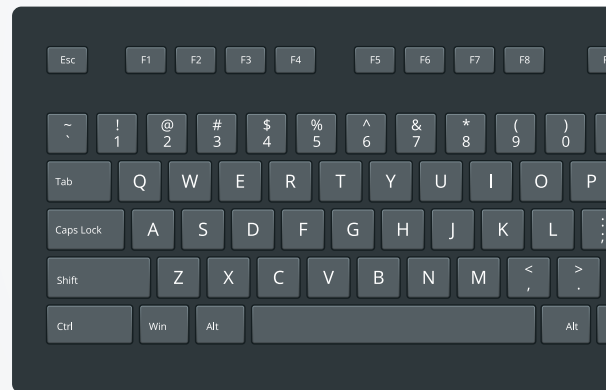
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Keyboards have a staggered design (the slight indentation at the start of every row of keys) because on typewriters, the levers underneath the keys would get in the way. Since people and typists were already used to this layout, it wasn't changed when electronic keyboards came.

ABS* is tougher and softer compared to PBT*. Hence, they last longer and although PBT shatters easily, it is preferred because of its longevity.

Back in 2008 a research was conducted by UK scientists and they found that keyboards can potentially contain high levels of bacteria usually found in toilets, especially office keyboards.



PBT keycaps dropped in a mixture of water and table salt will sink to the bottom, because of its higher density, other keycaps won't.



ABS keys get shiny quicker because of the lower hardness, hence PBT or POM keycaps are preferred when buying extra keycaps.

According to a research conducted at the University of California, horizontal and vertical key spacing of 19 x 19 mm is the most efficient.

Among all the types of plastics used in keycaps, POM* keys are the most expensive. They are abrasion-resistant so they won't go shiny, ending up lasting longer. They are also resistant to most of the solvents, hence you won't come across discolouration or wearing out due to contact with liquids.